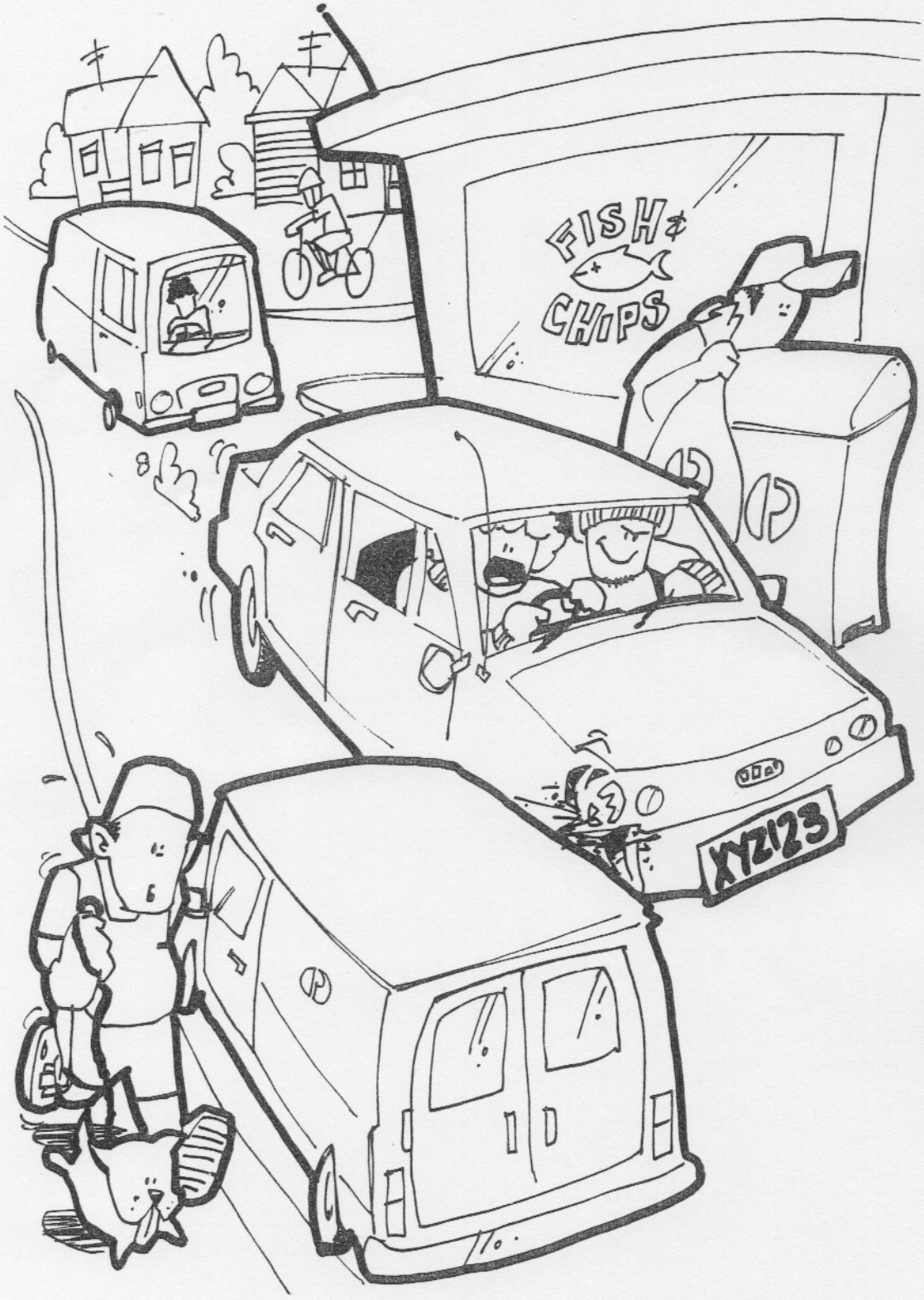
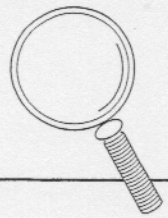
1-2 How observant are you?

Below is a scene that could occur in any suburban street. Look at it for 30 seconds, then turn over the page and answer the questions in your science book. First write the heading 'How Good a Witness Am I?'



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How observant are you?



?

Questions

1. How many vehicles are in the picture?
2. How many children are in the picture? What are they doing?
3. How many people are in the car? Describe them in as much detail as you can.
4. What type of car is it? Is there anything different about the car?
5. What is the man on the other side of the road doing?
6. How would you describe the location of the scene?
7. Describe the parked car.
8. What can you recall about the houses in the street?
9. Are there any animals in the picture? If so, how many and what are they doing?
10. Can you remember anything else about the picture?

Look back at the picture and tick every answer that was correct. How did you go? Would you make a good police witness?

This exercise depends on careful observation and an accurate memory. Unfortunately, when most crimes are committed, witnesses are not expecting anything and are caught unawares. Often, a witness may not even realise a crime is taking place until some time afterwards. However, many offenders have been caught thanks to accurate eyewitness accounts. Good witnesses can lead to possible suspects, or they may help the police investigators look in the right place for possible clues.

11. Imagine you were watching the scene on the previous page. You would be an eye witness. A few minutes after this scene took place, a police car drove up and told you that they were chasing some people they believe may have taken part in robbing a bank a few minutes ago back along the street. Make a list of at least five separate pieces of information that you saw, that might help them to see if they were involved.
12. How many English words, that are not proper nouns, can you make with the letters in the word 'OBSERVANT'?

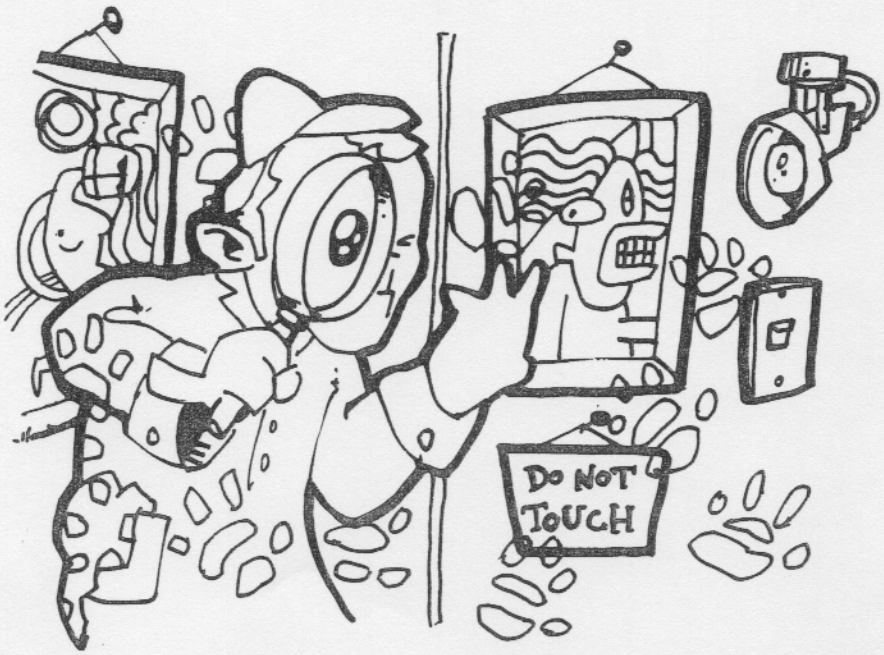
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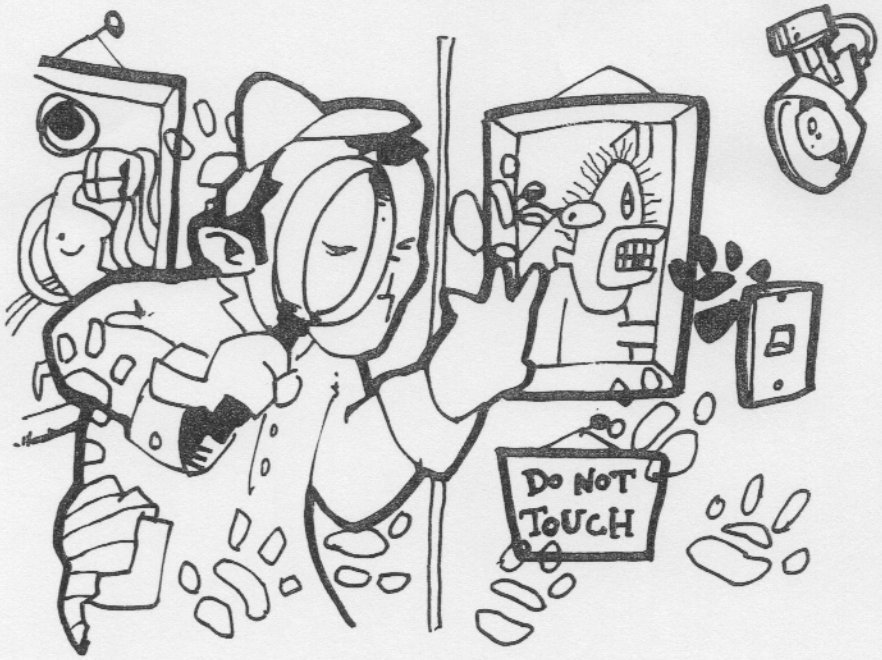
1-3 Looking for differences

To be a good detective or forensic scientist, you must have good observation skills, and be able to detect small differences and objects out of place.

Question

Look carefully at the two pictures drawn below. In your science book, under the heading 'Looking for Differences', write down as many differences as you can find. You should be able to find about 15.





Score

- Less than 4 – keep trying
- Over 4 – not bad for a newcomer to forensics
- Over 8 – good detective work
- Over 12 – brilliant detective work

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